

MIRROR PAGE

Implementation plan for Hours 12 to 100. Four comic heroes, one narrator, two vampires: friend or villain? Reveal or kill.

Developer	Sankeerth Nara (solo)	Repository	github.com/SankeerthNara/TGC-Game-Jam (public, MIT)
Themes	Comic, Twist, Light (all three)	Engine	Godot 4.7, GDScript, Compatibility renderer, Web export
Final playtime	12 to 15 minutes (20 max)	Plan status	Concept locked at Hour 12. Features below are committed or marked stretch.

1. THE GAME IN ONE PARAGRAPH

A fixed **Narrator** frames four comic stories. Each level is built for one comic hero (superhero pulp, noir detective, manga ninja, pop-art space hero), whom you play, and the map is themed that way. Each level is a pitch-dark floor of 8 rooms in a random layout; only the area around your torch is lit. You finish interactive tasks to fill a progress bar. The comic's **villain** is hiding as one of two **vampires** in the dark and keeps sabotaging you; the other vampire is your **friend**. Catch a vampire in your torchlight and choose **REVEAL** or **KILL**. After four levels you fight the **Narrator** in the final boss fight.

If the vampire is...	REVEAL	KILL
The friend	He becomes your ally. He no longer fears light and helps with tasks, hints and later the boss fight.	The friend dies. You lose him for the run, the Narrator reacts, and your ending and boss fight get harder.
The villain	He is unmasked and you fight him (short fight, torch beam as the weapon). Win and the sabotage stops, plus you gain a heart.	The villain dies at once and the sabotage stops, but there is no reward fight and no heart bonus.

Already built and verified at Hour 12: the dark level with torch lighting and smooth 8-direction movement, a generator for random 8-room levels (4 difficulty tiers), 13 interactive task types (classic, comic, college and the original light-puzzle pages with their rule twists), a progress bar, sabotage countdowns with fix consoles, hearts, checkpoints and respawn, level and total timers, a map screen, comic UI and menus, CC0 audio, validators, unit tests and a browser build. The existing sabotage system will be driven by the villain vampire instead of by task completion.

2. COMMITTED FEATURES FOR THE REMAINING 88 HOURS

#	Feature	What it adds	Hours
1	Fixed Narrator and four comic heroes	One narrator character (portrait, speech bubbles, text blips) comments on events through all four levels. Four original comic heroes (no existing characters) with their own costume and a small ability, and four themed levels: palette, fonts, props, room names, task skins and music (Comic).	16
2	Vampires and the Reveal / Kill choice	Two vampires per level wander the dark and flee from torchlight. Hold the beam on one to freeze it and choose. The friend leaves helpful clues (quietly finishes a console, drops notes); the villain is seen near consoles just before a sabotage and leaves ink drips. The villain vampire triggers the sabotage timers. All four outcomes have different results (Light + Twist).	18
3	The friend ally	A revealed friend follows you, is not scared by light, slowly completes tasks and shows where the villain is. Killed friends change the ending.	6
4	Villain fight (small fight, every level)	One reusable arena fight with four villains, each with a different attack pattern. The torch beam is the weapon; hits on you cost hearts.	10
5	Final boss: the Narrator	After level 4, three phases: the Narrator snuffs your torch, floods the floor with ink and attacks the interface; rotating arena mirrors bounce your beam onto his shield. Surviving allies help. Three ending variants depend on your choices (Twist).	11
6	Fourth-wall twists	The Narrator tampers with captions, the progress bar, the map and the controls for short moments.	3
7	Comic look and juice	Ink and halftone screen shader, panel-split level transitions, onomatopoeia on actions and hits.	4
8	Medals	S/A/B per level from time and hearts lost; best splits saved locally.	2
9	First-minute polish	30 second tutorial, controls hints, itch.io page with GIFs, README, CREDITS, AI usage log.	5
10	Balance and testing	Tuning of tasks, timers, clues and fights; outside playtests; bug fixing; web performance.	9

STRETCH (only after all of the above are playable, in this order): light puzzle rooms in the world, a torch battery with recharge lamps, reactive music. **Cut first** if time is short: stretch items, then medals, then hero abilities, then the per-hero task skins (fallback: palette swaps only), then the boss mirror phase (fallback: a two-phase boss with torch damage only).

Fixed limits: 4 levels and 4 heroes (no more), original characters only (no existing comic heroes or villains), no multiplayer, no save slots, no level editor, no new engine features.

3. ROADMAP AND MILESTONES

Hours	Work	Exit criteria (a playable build every 12 hours)
12 - 30	Plan locked. Clean-up of unused code. Narrator system (portrait, bubbles, event lines). Hero and theme for level 1. Vampire movement (patrol, flee from light, freeze in the beam). Tutorial skeleton.	Level 1 plays start to finish in the browser with the Narrator and a vampire to catch.
30 - 55	Reveal / Kill choice and all four outcomes, friend and villain clues, villain triggers sabotage, friend ally, villain fight (reusable arena). Heroes and themes for levels 2 and 3.	Levels 1 to 3 playable with both vampires, the choice and the villain fight.
55 - 75	Level 4 hero and theme, the Narrator boss fight (three phases, mirrors, allies), endings, level transitions, fourth-wall twists, shader, medals, audio mix.	Full 12 to 15 minute run from menu through the boss to an ending.
75 - 85	Balance pass, outside playtests, bug fixing, performance, accessibility. Feature freeze at Hour 85.	No known blocking bugs; clues and fights confirmed fair by testers.
85 - 96	Only fixes. Final web export, itch.io page and GIFs, README, CREDITS and AI usage audit, commit history check.	Public itch.io build submitted by Hour 96.
96 - 100	Safety margin. Re-verify the live itch.io build and the repository.	Strict code freeze at Hour 100.

4. HOW THE WORK IS SPLIT

- **Claude Code:** architecture, vampire AI and the choice system, fights, level generator, narrator event scripting, bug fixing, code review and merges.
- **Antigravity:** hero and villain art, level themes, UI, shaders and transitions, audio, browser (Playwright) playtests, the itch.io page.
- **ChatGPT / Codex:** tests, balance data, documentation, README and CREDITS, small isolated features.
- **Developer (Sankeerth):** all design decisions, the story, hero and villain concepts, the Narrator's script, the playtests, every merge to `main`. Design choices are logged in `docs/DESIGN_LOG.md`.
- **Method:** each tool works in its own git worktree and owns separate folders, a shared task board (`docs/TASKS.md`) tracks everything, commits are small and frequent so the history is auditable.

5. QUALITY, COMPLIANCE AND RISKS

Area	Plan
Stability	Headless unit tests for the puzzle model, level validator for every puzzle, a generator test that builds 100+ levels and checks reachability, a Playwright browser run on every milestone build.
Assets	Only free, CC0, CC BY, open-source or AI-generated assets. Everything listed in <code>CREDITS.md</code> and on the itch.io page. No paid assets.
AI disclosure	Claude Code, Antigravity and ChatGPT/Codex are used for code, art, audio and documents. Every use is logged in <code>docs/AI_USAGE.md</code> . Core design and story direction are the developer's.
Code origin	All game code is written inside the 100 hours. Only a generic empty Godot project and an editor plugin used for tooling (not part of the game) were present at the start; the plugin is credited.
Risk: the choice is a coin flip	Clues are deterministic: the friend always finishes one console unseen, the villain is always present near a console when a sabotage starts. Playtests check that testers can deduce the roles. Fallback: the first vampire met is always the friend in level 1 (tutorial).
Risk: vampire AI is hard to tune	Keep it simple (patrol, flee from light, freeze in the beam). Fallback: the villain sabotages on a fixed schedule.
Risk: scope (largest plan item)	The vampire, choice and ally system is built first (Hours 12 to 55) and everything else is cut around it, never the other way round.
Risk: combat is not fun	Both fights reuse existing mechanics (torch light, mirrors, hearts). Attacks are slow and readable. Playtests at Hour 45 (villain fight) and Hour 70 (boss). Fallbacks: the villain fight becomes a freeze-and-catch moment, the boss drops to two phases without mirrors.
Risk: art style workload	Genres are palette, font and caption swaps over one shared set of procedural shapes. Fallback: two genres instead of four.
Risk: web performance	2D lights are limited to the hero's torch; test every milestone in a browser; keep the export under 40 MB.
Risk: AI quota limits	Work is split across three tools with a handoff note on the task board; the developer reassigns tasks to whichever tool has quota left.

6. DEFINITION OF DONE

- A public itch.io page with a playable browser build of the full 12 to 15 minute game.
- The README shows the itch.io link, setup, controls and team details. CREDITS and the AI usage log are complete.
- The final game matches this plan: all committed features present, nothing from the cut list promised.